



SINDHU GANGADHARAN

47, SVP & MD, SAP LABS INDIA; HEAD, SAP USER ENABLEMENT

Shaping the Techade

UNDER SINDHU GANGADHARAN'S leadership, SAP Labs India has emerged as the German enterprise software company's largest R&D centre globally. This means that 40 per cent of its global R&D workforce is based in India. "What started as a

small organisation of 100 developers is now a strong family of 15,000-plus people," says Gangadharan. Interestingly, it is the only location to host SAP's entire product portfolio. "I am proud to have been associated with this journey of driv-

WHAT KEEPS ME GOING

Commitment to innovation and its transformative power to make meaningful impact

A LIFE LESSON LEARNT ON THE JOB

Resilience—the ability to bounce back and adapt to change

ing more investments to India, building on India's product engineering and creating more job opportunities for young Indians," she says. The company is coming up with a new campus in Devanahalli in Bengaluru, which, she says, will generate 15,000 more jobs in the Indian technology space. Moreover, as SAP globally made the transition to a cloud company, India has been among the fastest growing markets for it, doubling cloud customers in the last two years. It has also partnered with Air India for its digital transformation.

Apart from her work at SAP, Gangadharan also plays an important role at industry body Nasscom. She was re-elected to Nasscom's Executive Council for the third consecutive time in March. Earlier this year, she was appointed Chairperson of the Nasscom GCC Council 2023-25, followed by her being appointed Vice Chairperson of the industry body. In this new role, she will leverage her experience in technology and corporate leadership to help shape India's Techade. "Shaping the Techade will be defined by our collective ability to move from 'technology potential' to 'technology impact' and will be built on the design principals of Innovation for Impact, Inclusive and Secure Scale, Ethical Build and Use of Tech and Human Centricity," she says. **BT**

— BY NIDHI SINGAL



SMITA JATIA

54, Vice Chairperson, Westlife Foodworld

HUNGER BOOST

Smita Jatia, Vice Chairperson of the country's largest burger chain operator Westlife Foodworld, has led her company to a high growth phase. Westlife, which operates the McDonald's franchise in South and West India, saw its revenues surge 45 per cent to ₹2,260 crore in FY23, while PAT surged to ₹112 crore, from a net loss of ₹1.7 crore. Not one to rest on her laurels, Jatia has set some ambitious goals for her venture. She plans to double revenue to ₹4,000-4,500 crore and increase store count to 580-630 by end-2027 from 357 now. In the medium term, Jatia says she wants Westlife to remain a modern and progressive food company. Beyond that she wants to run great restaurants. **BT**

— BY ARNAB DUTTA